

Character Classes

CLERICS

At the first 3 levels of experience, the power of a cleric is extremely limited. As characters advance to higher levels (possibly as high as 36th), clerics obtain more spells of greater power, having proven their faith to their god or goddess. Because of this, it is very important for clerics to be faithful to the beliefs of their religion and alignment. Should a cleric behave in a manner that is not pleasing to his or her deity, the deity may become angered and punish the offender. This punishment could take many forms; some examples are a -1 penalty on "to hit" rolls, sending the cleric on a dangerous quest, or refusing to give the cleric any spells at all! The DM may decide what the punishment might be in such a case. To regain the favor of the deity, a cleric might find it wise to donate money and magic items to the religion, build a church or temple, gain large numbers of converts, or defeat some great foe of the religion. Again, the exact details are left to the DM.

When clerics reach 9th level (Matriarch/Patriarch), they may choose to construct a **castle** (see p. X52) or stronghold. If they have not lost the favor of their deity, the cost of building the castle will be half the normal amount due to miraculous assistance from the deity. For example, if a cleric spends 50,000 gp on a castle, the cleric would actually be able to build a structure that normally costs 100,000 gp. Furthermore, once the castle is completed, fanatically loyal troops (the "faithful", who never need to check morale) will come to defend the cleric. There will be from 50-300 soldiers (5d6 x 10), from 1-2nd level, armed with various weapons. It is up to the DM to determine their exact composition (how many archers, how many cavalry, etc.).

Clerics vs. Undead: When a cleric attempts to **Turn** one or more of the undead, consult the **Clerics vs. Undead** table (page X5). Cross-index the cleric's level with the type of **undead** encountered. The result will be a dash ("—"), a **number**, a **T**, or a **D**.

"—" means "**no effect**"; the cleric cannot **Turn** that type of undead monster.

A **number** means that the cleric has a chance of **Turning** some or all of the **undead**. If the player rolls the given number (or greater) on 2d6, then some of the **undead** monsters are **Turned**. If the cleric rolls less than the given number, the attempt fails.

A "**T**" means that the cleric automatically **Turns** some or all of the **undead** monsters.

A "**D**" means that the cleric automatically **Dispels** (destroys or disintegrates) some or all of the **undead** monsters.

A cleric may **Turn** or **Dispel** 2-12 (2d6) hit dice of **undead**. If the hit dice total of the undead is greater than the number rolled by the cleric, those **undead** whose hit dice are totally cancelled by the cleric's roll (the weakest) will be affected first. At least 1 creature will always be affected. For example, Antonius the Wise, a 10th level Patriarch, encounters 3 mummies (5 + 1 HD). At best, Antonius will only be able to **Dispel** 2 of the mummies (10 hit dice total). He rolls 2 dice and obtains a result of 9. Only 1 mummy is dispelled (9-5=4; the remainder is not enough to dispel a second 5 HD creature). If Antonius had encountered 6 skeletons (1 HD), all of them would have been destroyed with the same dice roll.

DWARVES

Dwarves are only able to attain 12th level maximum. However, this is balanced by the dwarf's special abilities, particularly the better saving throws and infravision. At 12th level, dwarves make formidable fighters.

When dwarves reach 9th level (Dwarven Lord), they may build **strongholds** and attempt to establish clans. The strongholds will be underground caverns and complexes located in either moun-

tains or hills. There will be many different clans of dwarves, each gathered under the protection of a Dwarven Lord, but usually only members of the same clan will live together. Dwarven clans are generally friendly with each other and may join forces in times of need, such as when there is a war of natural disaster. Dwarven Lords may hire only dwarven mercenaries, but specialists and retainers of other races may be offered other positions.

ELVES

An elf may only advance up to 10th level (Wizard-Lord). However, this is balanced by the elf's special abilities, especially the ability to both fight and cast spells. This combination makes elves far more powerful than a human of the same level.

When elves reach 9th level they may build a special kind of stronghold deep in the forest. This stronghold must blend harmoniously and pleasingly with its surroundings, usually a natural site of great beauty. Typical locations are in the tops of great trees, on the edges of quiet vales, or behind rushing waterfalls. Because of the effort to beautify the work, the structure will cost as much as similar work if made of stone, even if it is not. When the stronghold is completed, the elven Wizard-Lord will develop a friendship with the animals of the forest (birds, hares, squirrels, foxes, bears, etc.). All normal animals within 5 miles of the stronghold will be friendly towards the elves dwelling there. Animals will be able to warn of approaching strangers, carry news of events, deliver short messages to nearby places, etc. In return for these services, the animals will expect help and protection from the elves. Elven Wizard-Lords may only hire elven mercenaries, although specialists and retainers of any race may be employed.

FIGHTERS

Fighters may advance as high as 36th level. Their rapid advances, both in combat ability and in their amount of hit points, make them natural leaders for the normal human settlements. High level fighters usually spend their time training and leading men-at-arms, clearing the wilderness of monsters, and expanding human settlements. Fighters with enough money may build a **castle** (see p. X52). When a fighter reaches 9th level (Lord/Lady), the character may become a Baron or Baroness and the land cleared and controlled by that character will be called a Barony.

HALFLINGS

Halflings will only advance up to 8th level. As with the other demihumans, this is balanced by their special abilities, especially their better saving throws and combat bonuses. Any time a halfling has enough money, he or she may build a **stronghold** (p. X52), which may attract a whole community of halflings. Halflings prefer to live in pleasant communities in fair countrysides of rolling hills and gentle streams. When not working or adventuring, halflings will spend most of their time eating, drinking, talking with friends, and relaxing. Their communities are called Shires, and their recognized spokesman is called a Sheriff.

MAGIC-USERS

Magic-users are able to advance up to 36th level. As magic-users reach higher levels, they will become extremely powerful characters, but it's a difficult task to reach the high levels. Their poor combat ability and few spells at lower levels balance the power they eventually achieve. Therefore, magic-users must be cautious at lower levels, for no player can expect his or her magic-user character to survive long without protection.

Magic-users may add more spells to their spell books through spell research. At 9th level (Wizard) or above, magic-users may also create magical items. Both of these activities are explained under **Magical Research** (p. X51). Upon reaching 11th level, a magic-user may choose to build a tower, provided that money to pay for